

Event Resource: Considerations for Inclusive Event Planning

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Event Planning

Who is on your planning team?

- Invite individuals who can provide a diverse range of input
- A culturally competent and humble team will think to ask the kinds of questions and utilize resources for an inclusive event

Selecting a Date & Time

- Consider cultural festivals and religious observances when scheduling your events
- Is the time of your event feasible for every one you hope to attend?

Choosing a location

- Is the venue(s) being considered accessible and comfortable for those with special mobility, sight, hearing, and/or neurodiversity needs?
- Could the potential venue be exclusive to others?
- Consider the following:
 - Entrances, elevators, accessible parking, and transportation
 - Quiet/sensory spaces, temperature, and lighting control
 - Single user restrooms
 - Lactation rooms
 - Captioning on media
 - Religious affiliations

If your event has food or drinks

- Consider the possible dietary requirements of your guests.
 - e.g., Halal, Kosher, vegetarian, vegan, common food allergies
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Marketing

Designing your poster or flyer

- Event descriptions **must include the accessibility statement:**
 - To make a disability accommodation request, please contact the event coordinator [insert Community/Hall Director name] at [insert Community/Hall Director email address] at least one week prior to the event date.
- Could the advertisement be unintentionally and indirectly discriminating?
- Could the event name, description, images used, or design that will be experienced by a segment of the community be seen as offensive or alienating?
- Be sure the material does not use stereotypes or language that stems from stereotypes about any racial or ethnic group
- Have multiple people review the advertisement from different perspectives
- Consider using professional translation services or well-qualified professionals to translate marketing materials into multiple languages

Where are you advertising your event?

- Make sure the advertising and signage are visible to a wide range of people and use multiple ways to advertise: Tommie Link, Newsroom, pavement chalking, atrium banners, etc.

Digital Accessibility

- Addresses the ability of people to access digital content (internet, virtual class materials, software, etc.) by considering the needs of individuals with visual, auditory, motor, and/or cognitive disabilities and individuals with changing abilities due to aging, accidents, or illness.
- Accessibility involves design for all with proactive, upfront planning and anticipation of diversity and disabilities without specific students in mind
- Learn and develop skills to create accessible digital content by visiting the [Badging and Microcredentials page on OneStThomas](https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/badging/SitePageModern/93816/home)  (<https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/badging/SitePageModern/93816/home>), then going to the [Current Badges Available](https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/badging/SitePageModern/94739/current-badges-available)  (<https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/badging/SitePageModern/94739/current-badges-available>) and selecting "Digital Accessibility"

Overall

- Be thoughtful and intentional when planning your event
- Include knowledgeable and diverse individuals in your process, do research, and ask questions

Resources for Support

- **Student Diversity & Inclusion Services** (<https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/student-affairs/student-diversity-inclusion-services/SitePageModern/164944/home>) (studentdiversity@stthomas.edu (<mailto:studentdiversity@stthomas.edu>))
- **Disability Resources** (<https://one.stthomas.edu/sites/academic-affairs/disability-resources/SitePageModern/71170/disability-resources>) (disabilityresources@stthomas.edu (<mailto:disabilityresources@stthomas.edu>))
- Your CD/GSA